

Antimony

51
Sb

This metalloid has two forms—one is a brittle, silvery metal, and the other is a non-metallic gray powder.

Antimony's symbol—Sb—is not associated with its own name but comes from *stibium*, the Latin name for an antimony compound called antimony sulfide.



Kohl is a dark eyeliner.

Ancient eye cosmetics

Compounds containing antimony have been used as black eyeliners by many civilizations. Known as kohl in some parts of the world, its use is controversial because the antimony and lead used to make it are toxic.

Painting of Egyptian Pharaoh Amenhotep I



This silvery semi-metal is hard but brittle.

Pure antimony crystals refined in a laboratory

A sad note

The death of Austrian composer Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart in 1791 at the young age of 35 has been much debated by historians. One of the popular theories is that he died as a result of accidental antimony poisoning from medicine that he had been prescribed. This painting called *The Death Of Mozart* by Irish artist Henry O'Neill depicts the gifted composer's last moments.

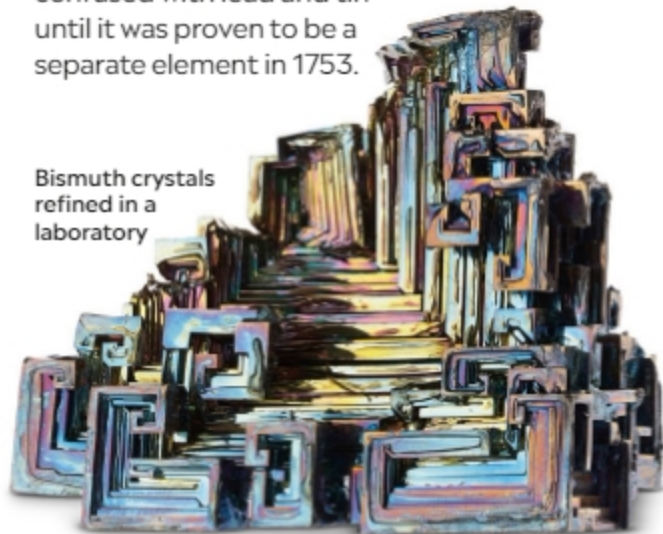


Bismuth

83
Bi

A heavy metal with a low melting point, bismuth forms incredible rainbow-colored crystals. An oxide layer on the surface produces bright yellows, pinks, reds, and blues. As a result, bismuth was widely used to decorate items such as wooden chests. Bismuth has been used since ancient times, but for a long time it was confused with lead and tin—until it was proven to be a separate element in 1753.

Bismuth crystals refined in a laboratory



Make-up

The shiny, "pearling" effect seen in cosmetics, such as nail polish, sometimes comes from a compound called bismuth oxychloride. When hit by light, its crystals produce a pearly sheen.

Moscovium

115
Mc

One of the newest elements to be placed on the periodic table, moscovium is named after Moscow, the capital city of Russia, where a significant amount of research for its creation was carried out. Moscovium is highly radioactive, and its atoms break up so quickly that it is hard to determine the element's properties, although some scientists think it may be a solid metal. Currently, it has no known applications.